

HSC Legal Studies – Shelter Question Summary

Extended-response questions for Shelter in Section III of the HSC examination, 2011–2025

Year	Part (a)	Part (b)
2011 Question 30	To what extent is the law effective in achieving just outcomes in regard to the provision of shelter? Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Nature of shelter	How effective are legal measures in resolving conflicts in regard to shelter? Cooperation & conflict resolution · Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Leasing · Dispute resolution
2012 Question 29	Assess the role of government in providing and securing shelter for individuals. Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Nature of shelter · Social housing	Compare the effectiveness of legal and non-legal measures in protecting the rights of those seeking shelter. Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Leasing · Dispute resolution
2013 Question 30	To what extent does the law reflect changing values and ethical standards in society for those securing shelter? Changing values & ethics · Law reform · Leasing	Explain how contemporary issues affecting those seeking shelter demonstrate the need for law reform. Law reform · Affordability · Discrimination · Homelessness · Social housing — <i>all four mandated issues in play</i>
2014 Question 29	Compare the effectiveness of legal and non-legal measures in responding to homelessness and issues of discrimination relating to shelter. Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Homelessness · Discrimination	Discuss how compliance with the law promotes justice both for those seeking and those providing shelter. Compliance & non-compliance · Leasing · Dispute resolution
2015 Question 29	To what extent have dispute resolution mechanisms been effective in resolving conflict with regard to shelter? Cooperation & conflict resolution · Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Dispute resolution · Leasing	To what extent does the law provide justice for those purchasing and selling shelter? Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Purchasing — <i>purchasing and selling only</i>
2016 Question 29	To what extent does the law encourage cooperation to resolve conflict in regard to shelter? Cooperation & conflict resolution · Dispute resolution · Leasing	Evaluate the effectiveness of the law in dealing with issues related to social housing. Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Social housing
2017 Question 29	‘The legal system is constantly changing as it seeks to achieve justice.’ Evaluate this statement with respect to at least one contemporary issue concerning shelter. Changing values & ethics · Law reform — <i>at least ONE contemporary issue required</i>	Assess the effectiveness of both legal and non-legal measures in achieving just outcomes in regard to the provision of shelter. Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Nature of shelter · Dispute resolution
2018 Question 30	Evaluate how effective changes to laws relating to shelter have been in reflecting changing values and ethical standards. Changing values & ethics · Law reform · Leasing	To what extent does the legal system protect those securing and providing shelter? Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Purchasing · Leasing · Other shelter types
2019 Question 29	Evaluate the effectiveness of legal protection and remedies in achieving justice for those securing shelter. Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Purchasing · Leasing · Dispute resolution	Assess the role of law reform in protecting the rights of those seeking shelter. In your response, refer to at least ONE contemporary issue. Law reform — <i>at least ONE contemporary issue required</i>
2020 Question 29	Evaluate the effectiveness of the legal system in addressing issues relating to the affordability of shelter. Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Affordability	Compliance with the law can be difficult to achieve. To what extent is this statement true in relation to laws governing shelter? Compliance & non-compliance · Leasing · Dispute resolution

Year	Part (a)	Part (b)
2021 Question 30	To what extent do courts and tribunals achieve justice for people seeking shelter? Cooperation & conflict resolution · Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Dispute resolution · Leasing	‘Legal measures often fail to respond to change.’ Assess this statement with reference to the provision of shelter. Law reform · Changing values & ethics · Nature of shelter
2022 Question 30	‘Legal responses are more effective than non-legal responses in achieving justice.’ To what extent is this statement true in relation to shelter? Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Dispute resolution	Evaluate the effectiveness of the law in encouraging cooperation to resolve issues concerning shelter. Support your response with reference to at least ONE issue. Cooperation & conflict resolution · Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Dispute resolution — <i>at least ONE issue required</i>
2023 Question 30	To what extent do legal responses relating to shelter address discrimination and homelessness? Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Discrimination · Homelessness	Assess the role of dispute resolution mechanisms in achieving justice for people seeking and providing shelter. Cooperation & conflict resolution · Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Dispute resolution · Leasing
2024 Question 29	Analyse the role of state and federal governments in responding to the rights of individuals accessing shelter. Nature of shelter · Social housing	To what extent are legal responses effective in addressing the issues of affordability and social housing? Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Affordability · Social housing
2025 Question 29	‘Non-compliance challenges the effectiveness of the law.’ To what extent is this statement accurate in relation to shelter? Compliance & non-compliance · Legal & non-legal effectiveness · Leasing · Dispute resolution	Assess the interrelationship between changing community values and the achievement of just outcomes for people seeking and providing shelter. In your answer, you must refer to at least ONE contemporary issue. Changing values & ethics · Law reform — <i>at least ONE contemporary issue required</i>

Patterns across the questions

Effectiveness and justice are the constants. Most questions require consideration of how effective the law is, or whether it achieves justice — usually judged for people seeking shelter and, increasingly, for people providing it as well (2014, 2018, 2023, 2025).

Four themes rotate. Legal versus non-legal measures (2012, 2014, 2017, 2022); law reform and responsiveness to change (2013, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2021, 2025); dispute resolution, conflict and cooperation (2011, 2015, 2016, 2021, 2022, 2023); and compliance and non-compliance (2014, 2020, 2025). Expect one of these four in any given year.

Named contemporary issues recur. Affordability (2020, 2024), social housing (2016, 2024), homelessness and discrimination (2014, 2023), purchasing and selling (2015), and the role of government (2012, 2024). Prepare evidence on each rather than one all-purpose case study.

Watch the directive verb. Evaluate and assess ask for a judgement; analyse (used in 2024) asks you to draw out the relationship between components; to what extent asks you to argue a degree, not simply describe. A quoted statement (2017, 2021, 2022, 2025) must be engaged with directly.

Some questions mandate an issue. 2017, 2019, 2022 and 2025 explicitly require at least ONE contemporary issue. Missing that instruction caps the mark regardless of quality.

Coverage matrix — questions against the syllabus

● - means the question is built on it — you cannot answer without it. ○ - means it is expected as supporting evidence or context. Blank means the element can reasonably be left out.

Question	Themes and challenges					Students learn about								
	Cooperation & conflict resolution	Compliance & non-compliance	Changing values & ethics	Law reform	Legal & non-legal effectiveness	Nature of shelter	Purchasing	Leasing	Other shelter types	Dispute resolution	Affordability	Discrimination	Homelessness	Social housing
2011 (a)	○			○	●	●	○	○	○	○	○		○	○
2011 (b)	●	○			●		○	●	○	●		○		
2012 (a)				○	●	●	○	○	○	○	○		○	●
2012 (b)				○	●	○	○	●		●	○	○	○	○
2013 (a)			●	●		○	○	●	○		○	○	○	○
2013 (b)			○	●	○	○		○			●	●	●	●
2014 (a)				○	●	○				○	○	●	●	○
2014 (b)	○	●			○	○	○	●	○	●		○		○
2015 (a)	●				●		○	●	○	●		○		
2015 (b)		○			●	○	●			○	○			
2016 (a)	●	○			○		○	●	○	●				
2016 (b)				○	●	○				○	○	○	○	●
2017 (a)			●	●	○			○			○	○	○	○
2017 (b)	○				●	●	○	○	○	●	○		○	○
2018 (a)			●	●	○		○	●	○		○	○		○
2018 (b)		○			●	○	●	●	●	○				
2019 (a)	○				●	○	●	●	○	●				
2019 (b)			○	●	○	○					○	○	○	○
2020 (a)				○	●	○	○	○			●		○	○
2020 (b)	○	●			○		○	●	○	●		○		
2021 (a)	●				●		○	●	○	●		○	○	
2021 (b)			●	●	○	●		○			○		○	○
2022 (a)					●	○		○		●	○	○	○	○
2022 (b)	●				●			○		●	○	○	○	○
2023 (a)				○	●	○		○				●	●	○
2023 (b)	●				●	○	○	●	○	●				

Question	Themes and challenges					Students learn about									
	Cooperation & conflict resolution	Compliance & non-compliance	Changing values & ethics	Law reform	Legal & non-legal effectiveness	Nature of shelter	Purchasing	Leasing	Other shelter types	Dispute resolution	Affordability	Discrimination	Homelessness	Social housing	
2024 (a)				○	○	●				○	○		○	●	
2024 (b)				○	●	○		○			●		○	●	
2025 (a)		●			●		○	●	○	●		○			
2025 (b)			●	●	○	○		○			○	○	○	○	
Core focus	6	3	5	7	19	5	3	13	1	13	3	3	3	5	

The bottom row counts how many of the 30 alternatives make that element a core focus. This is one reading of the questions, not an official mapping

Column key

- **Cooperation & conflict resolution** — the role of the law in encouraging cooperation and resolving conflict in regard to shelter
- **Compliance & non-compliance** — issues of compliance and non-compliance
- **Changing values & ethics** — laws relating to shelter as a reflection of changing values and ethical standards
- **Law reform** — the role of law reform in protecting the rights of those seeking shelter
- **Legal & non-legal effectiveness** — the effectiveness of the legal and non-legal responses in achieving just outcomes in regard to the provision of shelter
- **Nature of shelter** — definition of shelter, the right to shelter, the obligation of state and federal governments to provide shelter, types of shelter

- **Purchasing** — private treaty or auction, systems of registration, sources of finance, protection for buyers
- **Leasing** — rights and obligations of landlords and tenants; protection for tenants, landlords, boarders and lodgers
- **Other shelter types** — aged care, residential parks and squats
- **Dispute resolution** — courts and tribunals, alternative dispute resolution, government organisations, non-government organisations, the media
- **Affordability** — contemporary issue
- **Discrimination** — contemporary issue
- **Homelessness** — contemporary issue
- **Social housing** — contemporary issue — public, cooperative and community housing

What the matrix shows

- **Effectiveness is the one constant.** The fifth theme — the effectiveness of legal and non-legal responses — is a core focus in 19 of the 30 alternatives and needed as supporting material in almost every one of the rest: 29 of 30 in total. Nothing else comes close, and no preparation can leave it out.
- **Leasing and dispute resolution carry the option.** One or both is core content in 16 of the 30 alternatives. Landlord-and-tenant law and the tribunal/ADR pathway are the highest-yield content in the topic; they also address the cooperation, compliance, and justice themes at once.
- **The four contemporary issues are not examined evenly.** Social housing is named most often (2012, 2013, 2016 and both alternatives in 2024). Affordability, discrimination and homelessness are core three times each — and discrimination and homelessness always arrive together (2013, 2014, 2023), so prepare them as one body of evidence.
- **Other shelter types are the blind spot.** Aged care, residential parks and squats have been core only once, in 2018(b), and otherwise sit unused. They remain inside "securing shelter", which makes them examinable and, in a broad question, unusually strong differentiating evidence.
- **Purchasing runs cold, then hot.** Core in only 2015, 2018 and 2019. Anyone who prepares tenancy material alone is exposed when it returns — and the 2015(b) stem was purchasing and selling only.
- **Two themes swing.** Compliance and non-compliance (2014, 2020, 2025) and cooperation and conflict resolution (2011, 2015, 2016, 2021, 2022, 2023) alternate as the second focus alongside effectiveness. Changing values and law reform tend to arrive together (2013, 2017, 2018, 2021, 2025).
- **The nature of shelter is rarely the whole question.** Core in five alternatives, usually where the stem names the right to shelter or the obligation of state and federal governments (2012, 2017, 2021, 2024). Elsewhere, it is the opening paragraph, not the argument.